

ANNA NAGAR

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Avadi » Ayyapakkam » Tiruninravur » Nerkundram » Moolakadai » Ayanavaram » Retteri » Padi » Ambattur » Tirumullaivoyal » Aminjikarai » Vysarpadi » Red Hills

Citizens groups say conservation of the waterbody should have been the priority, not its beautification

L. KANTHIMATHI

Visitors to the park at Retteri lake at Retteri junction on GNT Road draw attention to sewage contamination in the waterbody.

Called Kolathur Eri Karai Poon-ga, this recreational space has been established by Chennai Metropolitan Development Authority at a cost of ₹4.98 crore under Vada Chennai Valarchi Thittam (North Chennai Development Scheme). It was inaugurated on February 3 this year.

The leisure facility sports walkways, gazebos, a children's play area, artworks on compound walls, 3D sculptures and models of musical instruments accompanied



Sewage pollution in Retteri lake after revamp

by notes explaining the science behind the sounds they produce.

However, visitors are unhappy about the pollution in the waterbody.

The sewage is conspicuous in the part of the lake near GNT Road and here all kinds of plastic trash can be found piled up. This spot

smells bad and therefore visitors avoid the walkway on this section; it remains largely unused.

Federation of Madhavaram Resi-

The four-month-old park developed under Vada Chennai Valarchi Thittam at ₹4.98 crore. The image was taken on June 8, 2026.

dent Welfare Associations and Tamil Nadu Federation of Resident Welfare Associations welcome this leisure facility. However the forums pointed out it should have been set up after the pollution problem was addressed. "For decades Retteri lake and its channels are polluted. Sewage is one of the major pollutants. It enters the lake from the surrounding neighbourhoods including Vinayagapuram, Korattur and Ambattur through illegal connections. Both the federations have been pursuing this cause with the authorities for many years but our efforts were to no avail. This park is a mere ornamentation to hide the dirt and squalid condition of the waterbody. Conservation of the lake should have been prioritised, not its beautification. This park is just a few months old and we expected this eyesore to show up in the new facility. It cannot be hidden for long," says D. Neelakannan, president of the federations.

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Buggy rides at Egmore museum a big help during summer

When this free service was launched six months ago, it was an instant hit; but the full measure of its benefit was made manifest only during the extreme heat spikes this summer

R. RAGU

The museum complex at Pantheon Road in Egmore sprawls across 16.2 acres, a surface area that can prove challenging even to legs, nimble and fresh from Nature's stables. The legs bent with age and arthritis would surely buckle under the strain sooner than later; so would the legs that have to walk around, young children in arms.

A senior museum official points out that based on visitors' feedback, the free buggy service was launched six months ago. While it was an instant hit, the full measure of its benefit was made manifest during the extreme heat spikes this



PHOTO. RAGU R

summer.

He notes that effusive praise has been forthcoming from senior citizens and women with little children to carry around.

Two battery-operated buggies have been pressed into service, and they are on rounds through the hours of the day the museum is open.

When not already into their rounds ferrying visitors, the buggies would linger around the ticket counter for anyone to hop on. The buggies would take a pre-designed route that touches select points that visitors are likely to visit and from there, likely to head elsewhere.

The official notes that both the buggies put together, the initial cost was ₹12 lakh. Easy to operate, the buggies are driven by the security personnel on the campus.

The buggies would take a pre-designed route that touches select points that visitors are likely to visit and from there, likely to head elsewhere

Departed for another sanctuary

V. Guruswami leaves behind a flock of admirers in naturalist circles

PRINCE FREDERICK

In the morning of June 11, if any birder in the field noticed a sudden drop in chirps verging on stillness, let them know that these birds sensed an instinctive snapping of a tie, the departure of a soul that sought to understand them selflessly. Not to make it to scientific journals and put on learned airs; nor to engage in social-media engagement farming. In their world, he discovered his own, one devoid of artificiality and filled with effortless comfort.

That morning, V. Guruswami departed for another sanctuary. A long life (he was 96), one spent with a great degree of autonomy (he bounced back to full health after a stroke in the fog end of 2011 and was in fine fettle till the last week of his life) is certainly a measure of blessing. But what was truly Guruswami's blessing was his ability to bless others with his knowledge, unconditionally without expecting anything in return. He leaves behind a flock of friends (nay more admirers than friends) at Madras Naturalists Society, a re-

pository of local naturalist wisdom. But anyone who has known him beyond birding field visits would instantly resist the temptation to pigeonhole him into the identity of a naturalist-birder.

The breadth of his knowledge was indisputably vast. To give an inkling, he could hold forth on the legendary kite flyers of Madras in the 1940s and in the same breath share the contents of his correspondence with Jim Corbett. He was rooted locally, deeply connected with the twin *jheels* (Manali and Madhavaram) as well as the verdant Simpson Estate in Sembium (all of them close to his former address in Thiru-Vi-Ka Nagar), but he had a global consciousness, always sharpened by a desire for knowledge, again not acquired for self-aggrandisement but to freely share with others.

His curriculum vitae would indirectly reveal how he went out of his way mining for knowledge in various fields.

"Guruswami was born on September 25, 1930, studied at CSI Kellet Higher Secondary School in Triplicane and graduated with a chemistry degree from Presidency College, Madras. He started



V. Guruswami (September 25, 1930 - June 11, 2026), truly erudite and incredibly humble.

working with the Ordinance Factory at Khamaria, Jabalpur, later moved to Addison Paints at the Simpson Estate in Sembium where he joined as a chemist and retired as a production manager."

That note is oddly familiar; one comes across that kind of a bio all the time; only that this one is silent on an extra universe of pursuits. Silent on reams and reams on the koel vocalisation, listening

in to the male koel's plaintive calls during the breeding season, year after year.

Silent on the incredible conservation story at the Simpson Estate, where he helped protect a heronry. Silent on the trends of various bird species he had documented and shared with journalists including this reporter. And silent on the numerous notes on the drift of things in various other fields he had penned, just for his delectation and those known to him. Unfortunately, much of this information was lost in the shifting of addresses. When he was advanced in years (in the early 2010s after his almost-magical recovery from the stroke) Guruswami and three other seniors in the family took the decision to move from Thiru-Vi-Ka Nagar to a senior-friendly block of an apartment in Sholinganallur with the support of the younger relatives in the family. Guruswami remained unmarried, and enjoyed a deep connection with his family, immediate and extended, and he was the favourite uncle and grandpa, no contests there.

And it was in this space on June 11, Guruswami breathed his last, nay let out his last chirp, not far from the Pallikaranai marsh synonymous with winged residents and visitors.



‘Stray cattle pose a threat in Sannadhi Street’

T. GUNASEELAN

Cattle movement is a concern at Sannadhi Street in Villivakkam. There are many banana vendors here and that attracts the cattle. This is a crowded street as there is a temple here.

There have been a few instances wherein these animals posed a threat to passers-by. Greater Chennai Corporation should attend to this issue.

T. Gunaseelan is a resident of Ambattur



Rajaji Nagar Kavary Street junction; and (below) the narrow Silandhi Kuttai stretch.

‘Widen Kolathur Main Road’

S. VENUGOPAL

It is time to widen Kolathur Main Road, a major thoroughfare in Kolathur. It connects Jambulingam Main Road near Chitti Babu flyover and Poompuhar Nagar First Main Road. The road witnesses heavy traffic but it is narrow and has got a few sharp bends.

One has to be wary of the vulnerable spot near Rajaji Nagar Kavary Street junction where a cremation ground is located. This is the sharpest bend on Kolathur Main Road. The narrow Silandhi Kuttai stretch and the junction where GKM Colony 38th Street, Dr. Ambedkar Street, and Akbar



Square First Street intersects are other vulnerable spots.

Footpath widening carried out a few years ago, narrowed the road further. But the shopkeepers have usurped the pedestrian facility by keeping their belongings.

A small bus connecting Villivakkam and Perambur is operated via this road. If the road is widened, regular buses can be operated.

S. Venugopal is a resident of Kolathur

‘Two shelters are unnecessary at this bus stop’

D. RADHAKRISHNAN

At 10 meters distance, there are two bus shelters for the bus stop near Institute of Mental Health on Medavakkam Tank Road in Kilpauk. Here, buses halt at both the shelters and therefore commuters are clueless about which shelter the bus will halt at.

They have to be swift to board the bus when it arrives. Given the number of commuters the stop witnesses, one shelter is enough and the other can be removed.

D. Radhakrishnan is a resident of Kilpauk



The bus shelters on Medavakkam Tank Road. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

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‘Suburban trains deviate from timetable’

CHARU NETHRA.M

Citing track maintenance, Southern Railway cancelled around 65 train services on the Chennai Central-Arakkonam and Chennai Central-Gummidipoondi suburban railway corridors. Next, the services that are in operation do not stick to the timetable. Most of the days, there is a delay and during non-peak hours, passengers wait for half-an-hour. Commuters suffer a lot on account of this.

Further, trains bound to empty stock or workshop are prioritised than passenger services. As a result, trains bound for Tiruval-



lur and Arakkonam are often halted outside Avadi station for 10 to 20 minutes during late-night

hours awaiting green signal.

Another major grievance is the lack of advance announcement regarding the delay which leaves commuters unable to revise their plans.

It may be noted, the service on these two corridors witnesses good patronage. Therefore, there should be a service every 10 to 15 minutes.

Train service is affordable, faster, and reliable than bus, so it is a better preferred mode of public transport. Therefore, Southern Railway should do restore those cancelled services at the earliest.

Charu Nethra. M is a resident of Avadi

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Chennai cannot do without air-conditioners, but their run time can be reduced if one designed their living space green and topped it with soft furnishings that have the visible imprint of nature. Here are roadside conversations with makers of bamboo and *vetiver* curtains

Rooting for green cooling systems

LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN

At the time of writing this (for the times-tamp-obsessed: the afternoon of June 11), the sun has been served a memorandum of suspension for its obnoxious behaviour in the past few days. An overcast sky has ensured the fiery orb stays out of work. Clearly a reprieve from what was an unusually harsh beginning to June, generally known as the pre-monsoon season even in the sun's long-held fiefdom, Chennai. Just as a lioness would deal an overly exuberant cub a surprise paw swipe, the joy could be short-lived for the Chennai people. Put it down to climate change, the weather has the vacillating mind of a Hamlet, and so it can be hot again before you know it. And it might not be too late still to "insulate" your house with cost-effective, heat-reducing traditional props. In any case, the benefits would carry over to the next summer and the ones beyond.

Here is a cherrypicked solution, one lying under one's feet. It is curtains made of *vetiver* (*chrysopogon zizanioides*), an aromatic perennial grass native to India that comes with an air of reverence, its fragrant roots occupying the front row in pujas. Off the religious altar, it is patronised for its cooling properties. When woven into curtains, *vetiver* comes into its own. A recommendation not to be ignored: *vetiver* curtains (also known as *khus* curtains) can be teamed with bamboo curtains for coverage of greater surface area, factoring in cost, the former taking a slightly oversized bite out of the wallet, and maintenance, the former again being the difficult one.

Why these nature-based solutions, NbS as they call them? This poser needs to be put to those who make a livelihood out of making these curtains. Enter S. Jagadeeshwaran and Nagarajan, who along with their teams, work by the roadside in Alwarpet and Adyar respectively, ironically soaking up the sun to help



people stay shielded from it.

With some assistance, a *vetiver* curtain can cut out the heat to some extent. Jagadeeshwaran explains that sprinkling approximately half a litre of water on the *vetiver* screens every morning and evening helps maintain a cool atmosphere, while the moist roots release a natural earthy aroma. "*Vetiver* stands out not just for its cooling properties but also for its herbal and medicinal benefits," says Jagadeeshwaran, owner of the family-run Jagadeeshwaran Bamboo Works on TTK Road. Jagadeeshwaran makes *vetiver* curtains too.

With a life span of approximately two years and costing

around ₹200 per square foot, *vetiver* curtains, says Jagadeeshwaran, can be an ally in keeping the sun in check. Let us not hoodwink ourselves into the outrageous, even hare-brained idea that *vetiver* or for that matter bamboo can replace technology-based cooling systems (aka fans and air-conditioners).

Along with sustainable design of the house, these natural curtains can reduce the use of air conditioners, thereby resulting in savings on the power bill. But the house has to be prepared for them. They would fare better in a house with a generous provision for cross-ventilation. They do not so much cool a space as

keep unwanted stuff such as too much sunlight and pollutants out of it. Having said that, the water-sprinkled *vetiver* curtains do bring in a whiff of cool air, but only so much.

Their environmentally friendly nature should be a strong incentive to pair them with tech-based cooling solutions.

Bamboo versus vetiver

Nagarajan, a maker of bamboo as well as *vetiver* curtains in Adyar (near the Aavin parlour park) is a believer in *vetiver* curtains, but tends to bat longer for bamboo curtains. From a design perspective, bamboo curtains stand out. With those roots, *vetiver* curtains can resemble the inside of an angler's worm box. In contrast, the neat lines of the bamboo strips, horizontal, vertical or cross-stitched, make the curtains aesthetically more pleasing.

"Available in a range of colours and finishes, bamboo curtains can complement different architectural styles while helping lower indoor temperatures" Nagarajan adds. Then, the cost equation. Nagarajan notes bamboo is also the more economical option, costing around ₹100 per square foot, against the price of ₹200 per square foot *vetiver* curtains come at. He adds that bamboo products are particularly popular among resorts, hotels and homeowners looking to combine functionality with visual appeal, whereas *vetiver* curtains are predominantly preferred by individual households seeking a traditional cooling solution. With electricity tariffs ever on the rise and heatwaves becoming more stinging, Chennai residents should not ignore these traditional options. Beyond being money-wise, this would signify a return to a sustainable practice that was once the norm, and now takes an article such as this to remind ourselves of their continuing relevance.

S. Jagadeeshwaran can be contacted at 9841565239/9003183916 and Nagarajan at 9941538328.

'Building design key to effectiveness of bamboo and vetiver curtains'

Architect and co-founder of Design Co Lab, Pavithra Sriram on when these traditional curtains, which she clubs among "materials that breathe", can be effective:

"The curtain system itself, whether it is a *vetiver* curtain or a bamboo curtain, is the last step of this entire spectrum. You are looking at a building that has to be designed in such a way that there is cross ventilation. Unless you do that, your reliance on air-conditioners is not going to stop. One *vetiver* curtain in an extremely developer-built apartment that lacks cross ventilation cannot suddenly make for Ooty climate. The entire building needs to respond to the local context. It is important not to look at these things as topical, band-aid solutions. They need to be understood as part of a holistic approach. The entire building environment has to work together. When that happens, elements such as bamboo curtains, *vetiver* screens and other traditional materials can play a meaningful role in improving comfort and reducing dependence on mechanical cooling systems."

Follow these green imperatives

A resource for the Environment Month: anyone planning a tree plantation drive would do well to heed these words of wisdom from groups that got onto the right path after a few missteps

LIFFY THOMAS

‘Get a declaration from the site owner’

In 2014, when Thuvakkam began its journey, the first project had to do with the greening of a patch on a campus. But as luck would have it, that green patch eventually gave way to a building with classrooms.

Lesson learnt: extract a promise from the owners of the patch, whether government or private, that the patch will stay green. But the same challenge has dogged us through the years, particularly where government-owned sites are concerned: there is no telling what will become of a patch that has been given a dash of green.

Recently, at a public park where we had undertaken a greening initiative, the government constructed an anganwadi, resulting in the removal of trees. Imagine our disappointment! For an ongoing project at a parcel of land owned by the Southern Railway, we have got a written assurance that the land will not be touched for five to eight years.

Krishna Kumar Suresh, founder, Thuvakkam

‘Make them allies’

After a plantation exercise at a government school in Puducherry, the headmaster called me days later to say that many of the saplings were missing. The needle of suspicion pointed to the students. I was shocked to learn that students had taken the saplings of fruit-bearing trees probably to grow them in their own backyard.

Lesson learnt: make them allies. This incident taught us the need to start a ‘Green Brigade’ where we give each child a free fruit sapling. These plants find their way into homes of students and other public spaces where they are nurtured by children. Under the Green Brigade initiative, we have so far given away many saplings.

To promote a sense of ownership, we started the practice of having a name board created at every plantation site. This has the name of the farmer responsible for nurturing the plants along with details of the plant species. But at one drive, I noticed that many saplings were left to wither in a corner, unplanted, as the people entrusted with the job of planting them had left the scene. After this episode, we make it a point to have the nameboard put up only after all the saplings are planted.

Prasiddhi Singh, founder, Prasiddhi Forest Foundation

‘Keep a backup plan in place’

We had planted more than 8,000 saplings on a 24-acre land owned by SIPCOT, Vallam Vadagal only to find that more than 60 per cent of them withered one harsh summer. The local civic body was providing water for these saplings and due to some reason the supply stopped affecting some young plants that needed water the most. Jackfruit and a medical plant used for cancer were the biggest victims.

Lesson learnt: one cannot rely on any institution for the continued survival of the saplings one had planted. So, before taking up such a massive exercise, have a Plan B, one particularly geared to meeting the saplings’ water needs. Knowing the soil, the groundwater table and the kind of trees planted is important.

At the same OSR site where we are growing a Miyawaki forest and raising a regular plantation, we have now arranged a 20,000 litre tank with a private supplier refilling it. We have replaced the lost plants with new ones.

Lt. Col. N. Thiagarajan, general secretary, Mastermind Foundation

‘Let go; or hang on till they see reason’

As part of their CSR initiative, a corporate had given us a list of plants they wanted us to grow and maintain, but a majority of those plants were not suited for Chennai’s climate. We tried explaining to the corporate how the location and the soil type plays an important role in the growth of plants but they would not listen.

In another case, an amusement park on East Coast Road wanted us to plant aesthetic-looking trees on their property. The problem with such trees is that they may not necessarily have a long life span and are not of much help to the ecosystem.

Lesson learnt: these two scenarios taught us to choose between two wise approaches. One, drop the project. Two, take up the work but make sure the client sees reason as you progress with the project.

Sreekumar Nair, founder, TREES

A second chance for everyday things

As a two-day garment mending workshop by Samposhan ends today, a close look at Chennai's repair culture provides cause for some celebration and also reasons to revitalise efforts to promote it

SHARON JESSICA MICHAEL

Wire it right

At a time when malfunctioning appliances are often discarded with little thought, Repair Café Chennai is championing an alternative ethos, one that prioritises repair and recirculation.

Launched in October 2024 by Meenalochani S, founder member of Repair Café Chennai, the initiative traces its roots to the Repair Café movement started in Bengaluru by Purna Sarkar. The first Chennai session was held in the portico of Meenalochani's home, bringing together friends and their children for a hands-on introduction to repairing everyday objects. "It felt very much needed for every child as part of the skills they should grow up with," says Meenalochani.

The inaugural event featured stations for carpentry, cycle repair, and electrical and electronic repairs. Over time, however, the Chennai chapter evolved into a series of workshops focused primarily on

electrical and electronics repair. "The electrical and electronics section caught up with us because we found good mentors for it who were willing to continue the journey," she says. "My daughter got to open up the devices and identify the problem herself. Now she knows electronic goods can be repaired instead of simply buying new ones," says one of the participants.

Since then the collective has conducted workshops with a school in Besant Nagar, collaborated twice with Goethe Institute, and organised sessions in public spaces across the city. Most participants have been homeschoolers, with some families travelling from Puducherry



During a session at Repair Cafe Chennai.



Operating from his main outlet near Thirumangalam in Anna Nagar, with branches in Mogappair, T. Nagar, Ambattur and Padappai, Aasai Muthu restores saris damaged by age, wear and accident. Torn fabrics, damaged borders, colour bleeding caused by rainwater, rodent-inflicted damage and faded hues are among the most common problems brought to his workshop.

The craft is a "hand-me-down" to Aasai Muthu. "My grandfather and father were both weavers. From childhood, I was surrounded by saris and weaving work," he says. "Even now, I can easily identify different types of zari and borders."

His clientele ranges from homemakers seeking to preserve treasured possessions to actors and other prominent personalities. Wedding silks and heirloom saris account for a significant portion of the work he undertakes, particularly from customers in Mylapore. "Many people bring saris that belonged to their mothers or grandmothers. They do not want to throw them away because there are memories attached to them," he says.

Restoration charges typically range from ₹500 to ₹2,000, depending on the complexity of the work involved. While the repair itself generally takes three to four days, the entire process extends to six to eight days, including approximately two days each for collection and delivery. Customers may either visit the workshop or schedule a home visit, during which Muthu personally assesses the sari's condition. As part of the service, every restored sari is returned with a complimentary dry-cleaning treatment, helping revive its appearance and finish.

One of the more unusual assignments he recalls involved a government official who wanted the border from one sari painstakingly removed and attached to another. Such requests, he says, underscore the sentimental value that many customers continue to place on their garments.

Yet, Aasai Muthu has observed a gradual decline in the culture of repair. "Nowadays, many people prefer to sell old saris and buy new ones. Earlier," he says. The challenge becomes even greater when dealing with saris that are decades old. "Repairing a sari that is 30 or 40 years old requires a lot of patience. We cannot bring back the original material completely, but we can restore it and make it wearable again," he says.

Call Aasai Muthu at 6380563972

to attend repeatedly.

Through pre-registered sessions lasting three to four hours, participants learn troubleshooting, continuity testing, soldering and basic appliance repair under the guidance of volunteer mentors.

Fees range from ₹500 to ₹1,000.

The initiative also sustains an active WhatsApp community where participants seek repair advice and share resources. Looking beyond workshops, the group is working to build a gig-employment network connecting skilled repairers with those seeking repair services. "Our mission is to create earning opportunities, empower skilled workers, and connect them with people who need reliable repair solutions," says Meenalochani.

Instagram - @repaircafe.tiruandchennai

Stitching memories

When a treasured sari is torn, faded or damaged, Chennai-based sari repairer Aasai Muthu is often the person customers turn to.

With over 45 years of experience, Muthu has built a niche business around restoring saris that hold sentimental, cultural and monetary value.



The last day of a restoration workshop

Samposhan, the sustainability enterprise based in Adambakkam and founded by Mamta Jain, has brought together environmental consciousness and creativity through a two-day mending workshop in Besant Nagar. Titled "Pause. Mend. Reuse.", the event (June 13 and 14) encourages participants to repair and reimagine worn garments, extending their lifespan while underscoring Samposhan's broader mission of reducing textile waste and promoting a circular economy. Through hands-on sessions, attendees learn mindful mending techniques and explore ways to give cherished pieces a new lease of life, demonstrating how a simple repair can be a small but significant act of sustainable living.

Instagram - @thesamposhan

Three sports administrators honoured

Aadhav Arjuna, Marie Wilson and J.C.D. Prabhakar play different roles but their love for sports is a common thread uniting them

K. KEERTHIVASAN

On June 10, the historic Museum Theatre witnessed an evening that celebrated sport and those who have contributed to its growth. Three sports administrators – Aadhav Arjuna, Tamil Nadu Minister for Public Works and Sports Development; Marie Wilson, State Minister for Finance, Planning and Development; and J. C. D. Prabhakar, Speaker of the Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly and former president of the All India Chess Federation – were felicitated by the Tamil Nadu Chess Association (TNSCA) and Tamil Nadu Table Tennis Association (TNTTA).

D. V. Sundar, patron of the TNTTA, lauded the contributions of the three dignitaries.

Aadhav, a former State-level basketball player and a passion-



(Left to right) B. Murugavel, vice-president of TNSCA, D. V. Sundar, patron, TNTTA, Vita Dani, Aadhav Arjuna, JCD Prabhakar, Marie Wilson, Ishari Velan and M. Manickam. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

ate sportsman has always been a strong supporter of athletes and sporting initiatives. Wilson, chairman of Jeppiaar Institute of Technology and a former basketball player, has also remained closely connected with sports. Prabhakar played a key role in bringing the historic World Chess Championship match between Magnus Carlsen and Viswanathan Anand

to Chennai in 2013.

Recalling his days as a student of the Sports Hostel, Aadhav said, “Sports gave me everything. As a son who lost his parents early, receiving scholarship at sports hostel of Sports Development Authority of Tamil Nadu and gaining admission through the sports quota at Madras Christian College was possible through sports.”

At heart, Aadhav said, he remains a sportsperson and assured athletes that his doors would always remain open to them.

“People call me BFI (Basketball Federation of India) president, Sports Minister. But I remain a sportsperson even today. I wake up at 4.30 a.m. and go to the Nehru Stadium,” he said.

Aadhav said the Government would give greater importance to sports in school education in the coming years.

Wilson, recalling his own journey, said he was a basketball player before becoming chairman of the Jeppiaar Group.

“Before I became a minister, not many knew me. I was a basketball player who played alongside Aadhav. Now, I am an educationist who has given admission to 3,000 sportspersons. All because I love sports,” he said.

Wilson advised students to maintain a balance between sports and academics, adding that the Government would extend strong support to the sporting community.

Prabhakar said the State Government would provide a major impetus to sports in the days ahead.

Rajmohan Arumugam, Minister for School Education, Tamil Development, Information and Publicity; Vita Dani, Chairperson, Ultimate Table Tennis, co-owner, Chennaiyin Football Club; P. R. Venketrama Raja, Chairman, Ramco Group; Manuel Aaron, India's first Arjuna Awardee (chess); M. Manickam, Chairman, Sakthi Group and president, TNSCA; and Ishari K. Ganesh, president, Tamil Nadu Olympic Association were among those present.

Real estate firm organises celebratory event



Tirthanighai Real Estates recently celebrated its annual ‘Kudumba Vizha 2026’ in the city.

Held at MCC School auditorium in Chetpet, the festival brought together the firm's channel partners, employees, business associates, and their families for an evening dedicated to recognition and inspiration.

Founded by K. K. Muniyanti, the organisation's chairman, the nearly four-decade-old firm has built a strong reputation on trust.

Muniyanti reiterated the organisation's long-stand-

ing vision that every family should own a piece of land.

A major highlight at the celebration was the recognition of channel partners, team leaders, marketing managers, and employees through a series of awards and documentary-style presentations that showcased their success stories.

The leadership team comprising K. K. Munusamy, S. Arun Kumar, K.M. Srinivasan, and K.M. Hariharan unveiled upcoming residential projects under the Tiru Thanikai Infra City and shared the organisation's vision for the future.

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During the event. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

DG Vaishnav College conducts faculty development programme

To enhance the professional competencies of faculty members and equip them with the latest pedagogical and technological advancements in higher education, Dwaraka Doss Goverdhan Doss Vaishnav College organised a faculty development programme on June 11.

P.K. Manoharan, Additional Registrar, VIT, who was the chief guest, emphasised the transformative role of teachers in society and encouraged faculty members to pursue lifelong learning and professional growth.

S. Santhosh Baboo, Principal of DG Vaishnav College, stressed the importance of faculty development initiatives in fostering academic excellence and quality education. He encouraged educators to strive consistently toward insti-

tutional growth and highlighted the need to integrate the 17 Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) into academic programmes and curricula. He also underscored the importance of innovation, technology integration, research, Intellectual Property Rights (IPR), startups, industry collaboration, and Outcome-Based Education (OBE) in contemporary higher education.

Ashok Kumar Mundhra, Secretary, DG Vaishnav College, stated that the quality of an educational institution depends on the commitment, competence, and continuous learning of its teachers.

The programme also featured expert sessions by academicians and industry leaders from various institutions, including universities, research organisations, and the corporate sector.

Book on self-awareness launched

Titled 'Read, Reflect and Rise', authored by Sangeeta Baid, was launched at Taj Connemara, Chennai, recently.

The book focuses on personal growth, purposeful living, self-reflection, and value-based living, according to a release.

Speaking about the book, the author said it is "an invitation to reflect on our experiences, learn from them, and rise stronger. True transformation begins when we become willing to look within."

The book is available on Amazon and can be ordered at <https://www.amazon.in/READ-REFLECT-RISE/dp/9369107630>



At the book launch. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Fiftieth show of Gopi Funchurian

Popular actor, mimicry artist, and stand-up comedian Badava Gopi will be celebrating the 50th performance of "Gopi Funchurian", a unique stand-up comedy and mimicry show, on June 20 at 7 p.m. at the Music Academy.

Unlike other conventional stand-up comedy sessions, this will offer entertainment for the whole family, said a release.

The 90-minute show will feature humour, mimicry, storytelling, sound effects, celebrity voice recreations, cricket-inspired moments, and amusing real-life incidents from Gopi's life journey.

In a release, Badava Gopi said, "Mobile phones and YouTube videos cannot recreate the energy, laughter, and atmosphere that audiences experience live watching Gopi Funchurian. The show is to be felt, and enjoyed together as a



family."

The 90-minute show will start at 7 p.m. Tickets are available on BookMyShow.

For details, call 9962886000

Website: www.badavagopi.com

Session on communication skills

Anna Nagar Orators Toastmasters Club will be holding its meeting on June 14 at Kailash Yoga Kendra, Y Block, Anna Nagar. Time: At 9:30 a.m.

According to a press release, the session will have members delivering prepared speeches and impromptu speaking.

The programme will also focus on leadership skills. The event is open to all and no fee will be charged. For details, call 9600016210.

Humour club meet today

Anna Nagar Humour Club is organising its meeting on June 14 at Shri Krishnaswamy Vidhyashram, Vaigai Colony, Anna Nagar West. Landmark: near MTC depot. Time: At 4 p.m. According to a press release, Rangadorai Ramanujam, retired DGM of BSNL, will be the chief guest. No fee will be charged. The programme is open to all. For details, call 89392 98790.

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